

“Making complex things simple, with an eye on what they could become

I'm Wolfgang, a product designer with a communications design background and 10+ years across start-ups, product companies and agencies.

I own the full process from research to shipped detail, and I'm at my best when I can do both: design hands-on and set the vision for where the product goes next.”

Experience

- **Complex, regulated domains:** 10+ years designing for technically demanding products: end-to-end encrypted messaging and VoIP, security and privacy, software analytics and data visualization.
- **Enterprise and B2B SaaS:** Designing for organisations as well as individuals: admins, compliance requirements, procurement criteria and public-sector tenders, alongside the daily end user.
- **End-to-end ownership:** Taking problems from research and framing through interaction design to shipped UI detail, across native iOS and Android apps and responsive web applications.
- **Design systems at scale:** Building, modernizing and governing multiplatform design systems: shared token architecture, component libraries, accessibility (WCAG 2.2, BITV 2.0) and documentation for people and AI tooling.
- **Design vision and direction:** Setting design direction beyond the roadmap and using it to align product, engineering and leadership.
- **Team building and leadership:** Growing design teams from a single designer, establishing design process and standards, and mentoring designers while staying hands-on.
- **Research-led decisions:** Partnering with UX researchers on research plans and validation, and turning findings into product framing and priorities.
- **Prototyping in code:** Building interactive, AI-assisted prototypes to test and validate complex behaviour early and give engineering a precise target.

Career

Wire

Lead Product Designer

Jan 2021 – Nov 2026

Secure collaboration platform for enterprises and government

- Joined as the sole designer, scaled the product design team twice and grew into the lead role, while staying hands-on as an IC across iOS, Android and web.
- Led design through the product's shift from consumer messenger to enterprise and public-sector platform, translating security and compliance requirements into usable workflows.
- Led the modernization of a legacy multiplatform design system: one shared token layer across three platforms, with documentation built for both people and AI tooling.
- Brought the product to WCAG 2.2 AA and BITV 2.0 conformance, qualifying Wire for public-sector tenders.
- Designed and shipped several critical new features (Federation, End-to-end Identity, Meetings, and more)
- Built coded interactive prototypes to test complex behaviour and align engineering and stakeholders before development.
- Set design vision beyond the roadmap and used it to keep product, engineering and leadership aligned through several leadership and strategy changes.

Fresh Energy

Senior Product Designer

Nov 2019 – Jan 2021

White-label consumer app for detailed energy analysis

- Established research and design processes and introduced rapid prototyping to test ideas before development.
- Matured the existing Material-based design system into a shared, themeable component foundation for a white-label Flutter app.
- Designed new user onboarding end to end, including hardware setup guides that walk customers through installing the smart meter.
- Designed and planned the implementation of key product features with engineering, including the profile section and the compare feature.
- Designed and launched a new marketing website.

Senior Product Designer

Feb 2017 – Nov 2019

Software analytics platform for enterprise engineering organisations

- Started as a freelance UI designer supporting a single development team and grew into the Senior Product Designer role, covering all product workstreams.
- Designed all major customer-facing areas of the product, including the dashboard experience and 3D software maps.
- Defined data visualization standards that made complex code and engineering metrics readable for technical and management audiences.
- Built a custom design system based on Material, shared by design and engineering.
- Set up design processes and helped grow the product design team to three designers.

Freelance

UI/UX Designer

2006 – Feb 2017

- Designed digital and brand work through agencies including Fünfwerten, Novamondo, qbus and Interactive Tools, for clients such as Deutsche Bahn, Deutsche Vermögensberatung (DVAG), NDR and the Eurovision Song Contest.
- Worked directly with clients such as Motor Music and Swisscom, covering projects from brief to delivery.



Education

2002 – 2006

University of Applied Arts Wiesbaden, Communications Design
Diploma

2004 – 2005 · Internships in visual design

Die Gestalten, 6 months (integrated internship semester)

Aimaq Rapp Stolle, 3 months

Pommesmajo, 3 months

1999

Max-Slevogt-Gymnasium Landau

Abitur

Skills

Design

Figma, Sketch, Adobe Creative Cloud

Prototyping

Coded prototypes in HTML, CSS and JavaScript; AI-assisted prototyping (Claude Code)

Systems and platforms

Design tokens, component libraries, Apple Human Interface Guidelines, Material Design, WCAG 2.2 and BITV 2.0

Front-end

Working knowledge of HTML, CSS, JavaScript, design systems

Collaboration

Jira, Confluence, Miro, and others

Languages

German (native), English (fluent)